

third-party way if you're managing a business and are worried (by now!) about metadata in documents.

Here's one site to take a look at: www.payneconsulting.com/products/metadataretail. Note that this is not a recommendation on *Digit's* part, but only an example of what's available.

Available at that site is The Metadata Assistant, which analyses Office files to determine the type and amount of metadata that exists. The software allows you to analyse and clean files of metadata. The Metadata Assistant can also be used to batch-process multiple files on a local or network folder. Additionally, you can analyse and clean files attached to mail messages and convert them to the PDF format for extra protection.

Metadata Assistant costs \$79 (Rs 3,500).

5.4 Miscellaneous Security Measures

5.4.1 Macros and Macro Viruses

Macro viruses are viruses that infect documents—files created in different applications which do not contain not only data (texts, spreadsheets), but also macros, which are programs created in a special high-level language. Such viruses can spread from one document or computer to another.

In a little more detail, a macro is a sequence of keystrokes or commands that are used to automate repetitive tasks. Today's macro languages are very powerful and can be used to write a virus that can be just as dangerous as other types of viruses. Since they work in Word they can be worse than other kinds of viruses by doing nasty things like putting passwords on documents or adding offensive messages to printouts. Any menu item in Word could be a trigger for the destructive payload.